



Finance Committee Meeting September 22, 2026

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=GH60EgKzkDo
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Muncie Common Council - Finance Committee Meeting Summary

Meeting Date: September 4, 2027

Report Publication: Civic Analysis Division

1. Pre-Meeting Hearings & Committee Work Sessions

- **Session Type & Topic:** 00:00:22 Finance Committee Work Session <U+2013> Proposed 2027 Budget Review.
- **Summary of Discussion:** Committee President Dale Basham opened the work session to review departmental proposed budgets for the 2027 fiscal year. The committee outlined the review process, noting that formal public comments on the budget would take place when the Common Council considers it for final action.

2. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** 00:00:22 The Finance Committee of the Muncie Common Council was called to order by Committee Chair Dale Basham.
- **Attendance:**
 - **Present:** Dale Basham (Chair), Jerry Dishman, and William McIntosh.

- **Absent:** None.
 - **Other Officials Present:** Mayor Dan Ridenour, City Controller Matt Wagley, Fire Chief Dan Berford, Deputy Fire Chief Daniel Nguyen, Building Commissioner Richard Rowling, City Council Attorney Brandon Murphy, and Communications Director Amber Green.
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3. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** 00:00:00 The meeting opened with the recitation of the Pledge of Allegiance.
 - **Approval of Minutes:** *Not applicable / Not addressed in the transcript.*
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4. Substantive Business & Board Action

The committee reviewed proposed departmental budgets and related financial items for the 2027 fiscal year.

Department Review: Mayor's Office

- **Item Identifier & Title:** 00:02:39 Mayor's Office Proposed Budget & Financial Overview
- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Mayor Dan Ridenour
- **Deliberation Summary:**
 - Mayor Ridenour reported that the city is currently in a positive financial position, operating roughly \$1 million ahead of the previous year.
 - General Fund departmental spending is tracking at 64% through August (slightly under the 67% prorated benchmark).
 - The administration discussed the ongoing financial impacts of Senate Bill 1 (property tax caps), estimating a cumulative reduction in property tax revenues reaching \$3.3 million by 2032.
 - Discussion also covered population growth via the "Make My Move" housing program, local income tax (LIT) distribution software corrections from the state, and a \$900,000 EDIT subsidy transferred to support the General Fund.
- **Item-Specific Public Input:** *None.*
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** *Informational review only; no formal vote taken.*

Department Review: Muncie Fire Department

- **Item Identifier & Title:** 00:36:44 Fire Department Proposed Budget
- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Chief Dan Berford and Deputy Chief Daniel Nguyen
- **Deliberation Summary:**

- Chief Berford presented the fire department budget, noting that the primary driver of increased expenditures is a 5% across-the-board wage and benefit adjustment.
- An increase in contractual medical services was attributed to mandated cancer screenings, blood panels, and treadmill EKGs, for which the department procured a cost-effective remote trailer vendor following changes with IU Health.
- The department currently has 110 active personnel, handles roughly 18,000 annual runs, and has budgeted \$125,000 per station toward local bond repayments for upcoming fire station construction.
- **Item-Specific Public Input:** *None.*
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** *Informational review only; no formal vote taken.*

Department Review: Building Commissioner's Office

- **Item Identifier & Title:** 00:44:51 Building Commissioner Proposed Budget
- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Richard Rowling, Building Commissioner
- **Deliberation Summary:**
 - Commissioner Rowling reported that non-salary operational lines remain flat, with office supply budgets reduced by \$9,000 based on historical underspending.
 - The committee discussed lot-mowing outsourcing agreements (contracted with Smith Family Nurseries) to maintain vacant properties efficiently.
- **Item-Specific Public Input:** *None.*
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** *Informational review only; no formal vote taken.*

Department Review: Information Technology (IT)

- **Item Identifier & Title:** 00:48:58 Information Technology Budget & Vendor Transition
- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Matt Wagley, City Controller
- **Deliberation Summary:**
 - Controller Wagley outlined the transition of IT service providers from CMC (following the retirement of Jim Flux) to Leap Services.
 - Contract costs under the new vendor are higher, prompting structured fund segregation to monitor IT expenditures effectively.
- **Item-Specific Public Input:** *None.*
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** *Informational review only; no formal vote taken.*

Department Review: Board of Public Works

- **Item Identifier & Title:** 00:53:37 Board of Public Works Proposed Budget
- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Matt Wagley, City Controller
- **Deliberation Summary:**

- Controller Wagley noted a 7% projected increase in health insurance costs based on consultant recommendations (down from initial projections of 13-14%).
- The 911 dispatch contractual agreement increases to \$1.1 million annually.
- Discussion also addressed stormwater utility fee calculations based on impervious surfaces and administrative tracking of line items running near capacity.
- **Item-Specific Public Input:** *None.*
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** *Informational review only; no formal vote taken.*

Department Review: Street Department

- **Item Identifier & Title:** 00:40:02 Street Department Proposed Budget & Road Funds
- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Adam Lee, Street Department Head
- **Deliberation Summary:**
 - Street Department Head Adam Lee reviewed the department's three mandated funds (Motor Vehicle Highway Restricted, Unrestricted, and Local Roads and Streets), noting that funds are non-reverting and consistently underspent.
 - Key challenges include projected spikes in road salt costs (estimated at \$130<U+2013>\$135 per ton on the open market after INDOT received zero bids for the district) and the 20% local match requirement for federal-aid projects like the Tillotson Avenue and East McGalliard road projects.
 - Capital requests include funding for a single-axle plow truck and ongoing sidewalk repairs.
- **Item-Specific Public Input:** *None.*
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** *Informational review only; no formal vote taken.*

5. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

- *Note: The presiding officer explicitly noted at the beginning of the meeting 00:00:44 that public comments would not be heard during the finance work session, but would be reserved for when the budget is formally considered for action by the Common Council.*

6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:** 00:18:46 Chair Basham announced that the Finance Committee will reconvene on Thursday at 6:00 PM to review budgets for the City Clerk, Police Department, Human Resources, Park Department, Human Rights Commission, City Court, and Public Access.
 - **Adjournment:** 01:19:07 Approved by Voice Vote (Passed Unanimously).
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